

Proposal Report - Judging Rubric (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Task Definition, Evaluation Protocol, and Data	Clearly defines the task, dataset, and evaluation metrics. Includes a well-referenced source. Demonstrates a solid understanding of the problem space.	10
Learning Model Selection and Summary	Identifies an appropriate machine learning model with relevant references. Provides a clear draft outline, including figures/tables, and ensures the model is feasible for the team to use.	10
Experiment Design	Clearly outlines research questions, variables, and hypotheses in a structured table. Provides a well-organized bullet-point summary of expected modifications/code for experimentation.	10
Experimental Results and Discussion	Plans how results will be collected and presented (tables, figures). Explains how results will test the hypothesis and discusses possible outcomes (confirmed, contradicted, or unclear) while ensuring clarity in expected learning.	10
References	Provides a well-formatted reference list with at least one page of citations covering Sections 1, 2, and optionally Section 3. References are relevant and properly cited.	5
Viability Test	Demonstrates ability to run and train the selected model. Includes screenshots and details on runtime, test set size, training samples, and training time per epoch. Confirms model feasibility for further development.	5

Penalty	Deduction
Past Deadline	Subtract 10 points for every day the submission is late.

Proposal Report - Scoring Scale

Judgement	Description	If out of 5	If out of 10
Excellent	Meets or exceeds expectations. Well-organized, comprehensive, and clearly articulated with strong references.	5	9–10
Good	Solid effort with minor shortcomings. Mostly complete and organized.	4	7–8
Average	Partial completion with moderate gaps. Some required elements missing or underdeveloped.	3	5–6
Needs Improvement	Significant weaknesses in structure or content.	2	3–4
Poor	Minimal effort or major missing components.	1	1–2
Not Provided	Required section missing.	0	0

Proposal Presentation - Judging Rubric (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Learning Task & Research Question(s)	Clearly defines the learning task and research question(s). Provides relevant background and significance.	10
Learning Model	Clearly describes the chosen model, its architecture, and how it aligns with the task. Uses appropriate references.	10
Experiment Design (Including Dataset)	Clearly outlines methodology, dataset choice, variable selection, and expected modifications.	10
Preliminary Results & Research Relevance	Presents early findings (if any) and explains their significance in relation to the research question(s). Anticipates challenges and potential next steps.	10
Quality of Answering Questions	Responds to judges' questions with clarity, depth, and an understanding of the research and methodology.	10

Penalty	Deduction
Over Time Limit	Subtract 2 points for every minute over the allotted 10 minutes.
Inactive Team Members	Subtract 2 points for every member presenting less than the required minimum of 2 minutes.

Proposal Presentation - Scoring Scale

Judgement	Description	Points
Excellent	Exceptionally clear, well-organized, and demonstrates deep understanding.	9–10
Good	Well explained with minor gaps.	7–8
Average	Addresses key points but lacks clarity or depth.	5–6
Needs Improvement	Major gaps in explanation.	3–4
Poor	Minimal effort and lacks relevance.	1–2
Not Provided	Section missing.	0

Final Report - Judging Rubric (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Task Definition, Evaluation Protocol, and Data	Clearly defines the project, task, dataset, and evaluation protocol.	10
Neural Network / Machine Learning Model	Describes the chosen model, loss metric, and key components. Justifies model selection and modifications.	10
Experiment Design	Clearly outlines research questions, hypothesis, variables, methodology, and baseline comparisons.	10
Experimental Results and Discussion	Presents results, discusses the hypothesis, implications, and includes relevant tables/figures.	10
Formatting, References, and Clarity	Adheres to formatting guidelines, proper citations, and clear organization.	10
Penalty	Deduction	
Past Deadline	Subtract 10 points for every day the submission is late.	

Final Report - Scoring Scale

Judgement	Description	Points
Excellent	Exceptionally clear, well-organized, and demonstrates deep understanding.	9–10
Good	Well explained with only minor weaknesses.	7–8
Average	Covers key points but lacks clarity or supporting details.	5–6
Needs Improvement	Major gaps in explanation.	3–4
Poor	Minimal effort.	1–2
Not Provided	Section missing.	0

Final Code - Judging Rubric & Scoring Scale (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Code Functionality & Accuracy	Code runs successfully with minimal errors.	1–5
	Model produces correct and meaningful results.	1–5
	Approach effectively addresses the chosen research question/topic.	1–5
Code Organization & Readability	Code is modular, structured, and easy to follow.	1–5
	Consistent naming conventions, comments, and documentation.	1–5
README & Installation Instructions	README provides installation and execution instructions.	1–5
	Dependencies and GPU requirements are clearly stated.	1–5
Use of Frameworks & Innovation	Effective use of TensorFlow, PyTorch, or other AI frameworks.	1–5
	Creative modifications or optimizations beyond standard implementations.	1–5
Efficiency & Performance	Optimized computation time, memory usage, and scalability.	1–5

Penalty	Deduction
Past Deadline	Subtract 10 points for every day the submission is late.

Final Presentation - Judging Rubric (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Learning Task & Research Question(s)	Clearly defines the learning task and research question(s).	10
Learning Model	Clearly describes the chosen model and architecture.	10
Experiment Design (Including Dataset)	Clearly outlines methodology and dataset.	10
Preliminary Results & Research Relevance	Presents findings and explains significance.	10
Quality of Answering Questions	Responds to judges with clarity and understanding.	10

Penalty	Deduction
Over Time Limit	Subtract 2 points per minute over the allotted 7 minutes.
Inactive Team Members	Subtract 2 points for each member presenting less than 1 minute.

Final Presentation - Scoring Scale

Judgement	Description	Points
Excellent	Exceptional understanding with strong justification.	9–10
Good	Well explained with only minor weaknesses.	7–8
Average	Adequate but lacking depth.	5–6
Needs Improvement	Major gaps in explanation.	3–4
Poor	Minimal effort.	1–2
Not Provided	Section missing.	0

Model Performance on Unseen Data - Judging Rubric (50 Points Total)

Category	Criteria	Points
Accuracy & Generalization	Performance on unseen data using evaluation metrics.	10
Robustness & Adaptability	Handles variations in new datasets.	10
Consistency with Expected Results	Results align with predictions from report and presentation.	10
Error Analysis & Explanation	Team explains successes and failures.	10
Real-World Applicability	Demonstrates potential beyond the original dataset.	10

Model Performance on Unseen Data - Scoring Scale

Judgement	Description	Points
Excellent	Performs exceptionally on unseen data with thorough analysis.	9–10
Good	Performs well with minor inconsistencies.	7–8
Average	Moderate success with some struggles.	5–6
Needs Improvement	Poor generalization with weak explanations.	3–4
Poor	Fails on unseen data.	1–2
Not Provided	Missing.	0

Poster Rubric & Scoring Scale

Category	Excellent (3)	Good (2)	Needs Improvement (1)	Absent (0)
Learning Task & Research Question(s)	Clearly defined and logically connected to the project.	Mostly clear with minor gaps.	Unclear or poorly defined.	Not included.
Learning Model(s)	Clearly explains the models, rationale, and application.	Mostly clear but missing some details.	Weak or vague explanation.	Not included.
Experiment Design	Well-documented dataset, modifications, and reasoning.	Mostly complete with minor omissions.	Lacks clarity and important details.	Not included.
Results & Connection to Research Question	Results clearly presented with strong explanations and visuals.	Mostly clear and relevant.	Poorly presented or weak connection.	Not included.
Visual Clarity & Organization	Attractive, organized, and easy to read.	Mostly clear with minor formatting issues.	Poor organization and readability.	No poster presented.